“But oh, how I regret it. He thinks I’m like him, believing in the same things as he does. It’s awful.”

“Have you seen him since?”

“No. But he’s been sending me gifts.” Rose looked down. “The oranges —”

“That was all from Reinhardt? Oh, Rose, you should have told me earlier. We could have sent it back to him.”

“But wouldn’t that only anger him more?”

“Maybe. But now that you’ve accepted his gifts—”

“I’m tied to him?” It was what she feared. “Today the Meister insisted I take the afternoon shift off. When I declined, he said it was on the orders of ‘my powerful friend.’” She took a breath. “What should I do?”

Léa looked at her with an even gaze. “What do you want to do?”

“I want him out of my life.”

“After all that’s happened, is that possible?”

“I don’t know.” Rose looked down at the letter in her hand. “I love André. I want to see him.”

“Josef said Reinhardt approves all travel requests for foreign workers”

“Then he could refuse my demand to go to Berlin?”

Léa nodded. “He could do much worse than that.”

Rose stood and paced. How could this have happened after one meeting? Heart thumping, she walked around the vegetable garden, kicking the weeds and tall grass. And the answer came—because she’d been kind and given him the salute. It was a mistake. She never should have spoken to him. The realization that it was her fault knotted in her stomach. She turned to Léa. “What can I do now?”

“Only you can decide.”

“What would you do if you were me?”

Léa thought for a moment. “From what you’ve told me, I don’t think he’s going to stop . . . maybe he expects that the gifts will eventually bring you to him.”

Léa was making it worse rather than better. “I’ll never go to him.” It made her sick to think of it. Again, Rose glanced at André’s letter. This should have been the happiest day of her life, being reunited with him, but it was the worst and all because she showed kindness to a Gestapo officer. “It’s not fair. Why me?”